

Bad user versus incompetent user

Incompetence can mean different things to different people. However, in general, it indicates the inability to do a specified job at a satisfactory level.

If users can use the system without any (human) errors and the way they were required to use it, you can call them competent users. Incompetent users often fail to use the system flawlessly on account of their ability (not system's problems). These users often need considerable help from others to use the system.

Bad users, on the other hand, may be excellent at using the system, but their intent is not a good one.

All incompetent users are inherently bad users of the system; however, bad users may or may not be incompetent. The reason why we need to understand this distinction is—one is curable while other isn't. You can make incompetent users competent by training them, but no amount of training would help intentional bad users.

Importance of change management

Most of the other system interaction related issues are the result of poor or no change in management during the full term of the project.

While AI has the power to transform the organisations radically, substantial adoption numbers are difficult to achieve without having an effective change management strategy in place. All the bases should be covered before you begin the implementation and continue it as long as it is necessary.

When you have a complete understanding of how an AI solution will help end-users at all levels in the company, it becomes easy to convey the benefits.

Only quoting the feature list of your new AI solution will not help; you will need to explain what exactly AI solution is going to do and change and how it will help everyone in doing their job more effectively.

A safer and less risky approach will be to pick tech-savvy users for the first round of deployments. They will not only provide useful feedback about the AI system you're deploying but can also highlight potential road-

blocks for a full rollout. Tech-savvy users can help you determine if the AI solution works as expected for their purposes.

These users then become your advocates within the organisation and help in coaching their peers when needed. They also help in creating significant scale buy-in within teams and potentially reduce the number of bad users down the track, too.

Educating users for better adoption

Proper training plan and established training use real-life scenarios and hands-on sessions—user feedback is welcome and will be acted upon before moving forward—not doing that means you leave out much unhappy right talent.

If you want to ensure smooth transitions and user adoption, start user education early in the process. Moreover, tailor it to each stakeholder group. You should provide them with baseline information and knowledge around AI technology as a whole and then deeper insights and information on the specific application that you're deploying. It will help in setting their expectations. Every involved member must understand the benefits of AI solution.

By educational initiatives, you can quickly dispel misconceptions about AI. For some of the stakeholders and users, especially the ones unfamiliar with how AI can help, futuristic technologies can be intimidating. This intimidation begets a defensive response and brings out the lousy user in them in various forms.

With proper education, the benefits of AI can become apparent to your team members and thus foster positive uptake.

If you centre the education on the fact that AI solutions will enhance employee's daily work and make it easier to handle routine tasks, make sure to highlight this aspect. When communicating with your employees, focus on the purpose of the change and emphasise the positive outcomes it would bring.

Even for executive leaders, it is vital to understand what is happening and knowing the capabilities or limitations of the AI system you're deploying. By investing time in acquir-

ing appropriate education, executives will be able to ask the right questions at the right time. Being more involved is necessary for them.

It is hard to recover from a lack of end-user adoption if you haven't invested enough in user education. So, make sure you have spent an adequate budget in educating users for better AI adoption. Create multiple formats that are readily available for various devices, including offline in-person sessions. When you roll out the training, measure the uptake and types of resources employees use most. It tells you which medium is more effective, and you can leverage it some more.

Going all out on education and training materials can minimise the chances of failure when employees start using the systems.

When you deploy new systems, there is a typical spike in productivity loss, which is generally a result of slow adoption and a long learning period. You can minimise this productivity loss with a proper approach. To ensure successful AI deployment, pair education planning with training.

Moreover, as a rule of thumb, education and training should not end after solution deployments. These must become a periodic activity to ensure that you can sustain all the positive gains.

Checking the performance and gaps

It is reasonable to expect a human user to demonstrate the same performance repeatedly for any given set of scenarios. You would also expect other connected systems to exhibit similar consistent behaviour for you to be able to trust the whole system.

It is essential to check performance for consistency and find any gaps as early as possible in the deployment phase. AI systems usually work on proportionate outcomes, and some variation at the solution level is already accepted. When you couple this inherent variation with the variation of several humans and other systems, it can quickly become unmanageable. Although each variation might have been acceptable independently, when combined, it can be problematic and result in poor overall performance.